

Two Feasts

There was once a couple who lived in a village on the **bank** of a river. They never had enough to eat, so when the man heard that there was to be a **common feast** in another village situated up the river, he was very happy. He was **ecstatic** when he received another invitation to attend a feast in the village situated **downstream**.

"I'm not having lunch today," he told his wife **jauntily**. "Don't keep any cold rice or fish for me!"

Though the old woman asked him to eat something before he **set out**, he refused.

"There is chicken at the feast upstream and mutton at the one downstream. I'll be going to both feasts!" he said.

First he decided to **row** upstream in his boat, but because the tide was out, the water level was very low and he had a tough time making his way up the river. By the time he reached, his empty stomach **emitting growls** of hunger, the feast was already over and the guests were returning home.

"I'm sorry, my dear friend," said the **host**. "The chicken dish was so good, there is not a **morsel** left!"

The old man **cursed**, then hurried to row downstream, **lest** he miss the other feast as well. But now, the river was in full flow upstream and he had another struggle to **ply** the boat downstream!



"Oh, god!" he **groaned**, now **faint** with hunger. "I'll never reach on time."

As he'd thought, the second feast was also over. The host said **compassionately**, "Even the plates are **licked clean**!"

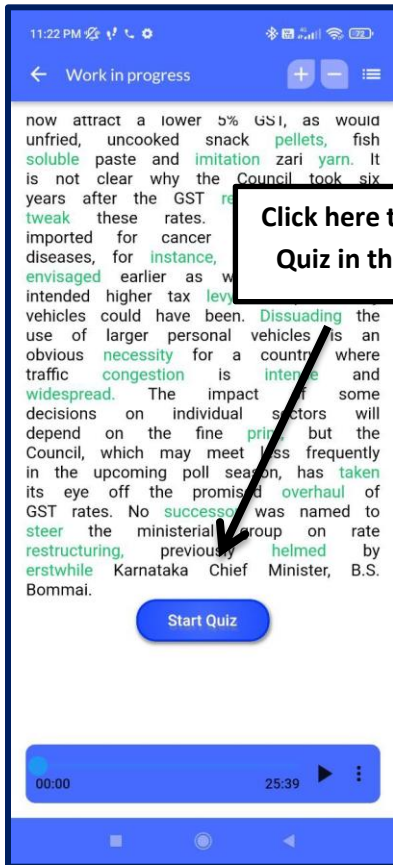
Now almost **collapsing** with hunger, the old man struggled back home. As he **staggered** in his wife asked, **mockingly**. "So, how were the two feasts?"

The reply was a **moan**. "Bring me a big plate of cold rice and fish dear wife."

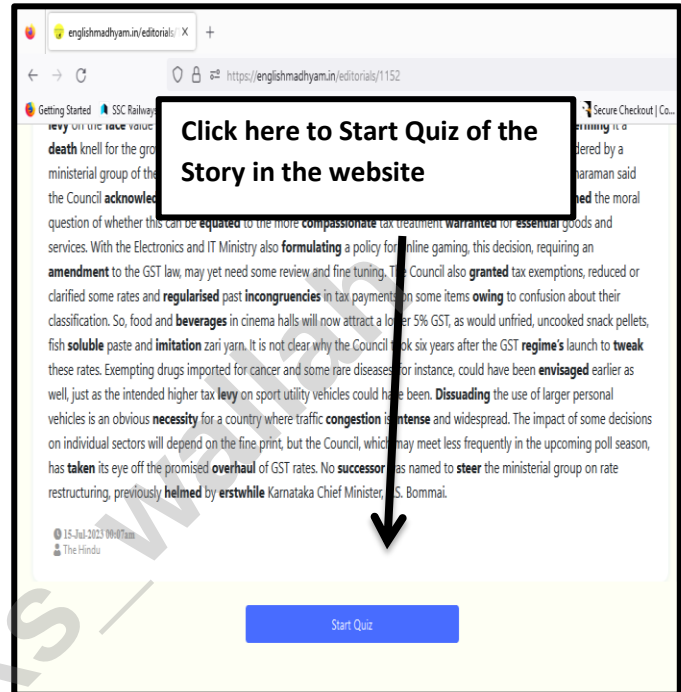
Vocabulary

1. **Bank** (noun) – riverside, edge, shore, embankment, verge – किनारा
2. **Common feast** (noun) – community meal, public banquet, shared feast, group celebration, collective dining – सामूहिक भोज
3. **Ecstatic** (adjective) – overjoyed, elated, thrilled, euphoric, delighted – बेहद प्रसन्न / आनंदित
4. **Downstream** (noun) – lower course, lower river, further down the river, river mouth direction, with the flow – नदी की नीचे की धारा
5. **Jauntily** (adverb) – cheerfully, lively, playfully, buoyantly, gaily – खुशमिज़ाजी से / मस्ती में
6. **Set out** (phrasal verb) – begin a journey, depart, leave, head off, start off – यात्रा पर निकलना
7. **Row** (verb) – paddle, propel, navigate, scull, move a boat – नाव चलाना
8. **Emit** (verb) – release, produce, give off, exhale, discharge – निकालना
9. **Growl** (noun) – rumble, grumble, roar, snarl, murmur – गरज / भूख की आवाज
10. **Host** (noun) – inviter, entertainer, organizer, provider, master of ceremonies – मेज़बान
11. **Morsel** (noun) – bite, piece, crumb, tidbit, scrap – कौर / टुकड़ा
12. **Curse** (verb) – swear, abuse, damn, blaspheme, condemn – गाली देना / शाप देना
13. **Lest** (conjunction) – for fear that, in case, to avoid, so that not, to prevent – ऐसा न हो कि / कहीं ऐसा न हो
14. **Ply** (verb) – maneuver, operate, row, steer, drive – चलाना / मेहनत करना
15. **Groan** (verb) – moan, sigh, complain, cry out, murmur – कराहना
16. **Faint** (verb) – pass out, black out, lose consciousness, swoon, collapse – बेहोश होना
17. **Compassionately** (adverb) – kindly, sympathetically, tenderly, humanely, understandingly – सहानुभूति से / दयालुता से
18. **Lick clean** (phrase) – completely eat, finish off, leave nothing, polish off, devour – पूरी तरह चाट कर साफ़ करना
19. **Collapse** (verb) – fall down, faint, break down, crumple, drop – गिर पड़ना / ढह जाना
20. **Stagger** (verb) – stumble, reel, totter, wobble, sway – लड़खड़ाना
21. **Mockingly** (adverb) – teasingly, sarcastically, scornfully, derisively, tauntingly – व्यंग्य से / मज़ाक उड़ाते हुए
22. **Moan** (noun) – groan, complaint, murmur, cry, wail – कराह / आह

Practice Exercise



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